

FILE

4. EXCISE

INFO	LOG-00	COPY-01	ADS-00	INR-10	SS-00	CIAE-00	000E-00
	H-01	NSCE-00	NSAE-00	HA-09	L-03	PM-10	PA-01
	OMB-01	ACOA-12	SP-02	SNP-01	PRS-01	SARN-01	SDEL-03
	SART-01	/057 W					

P 241615Z OCT 86
FM AMEMBASSY MOSCOW
TO SECSTATE WASHDC PRIORITY 2230
INFO MOSCOW POLITICAL COLLECTIVE
USIA WASHDC 6495
AMEMBASSY BRUSSELS
AMEMBASSY THE HAGUE

C O N F I D E N T I A L SECTION 01 OF 03 MOSCOW 18493

E.O. 12356 DECL: OADR
TAGS: FARM, PROP, UR
SUBJECT: SOVIET PUBLIC LINE ON REYKJAVIK
REFS: (A) MOSCOW 18038 (B) MOSCOW 18082

1. CONFIDENTIAL - ENTIRE TEXT.

SUMMARY

2. TWO WEEKS AFTER REYKJAVIK, THE SOVIET PUBLIC CAMPAIGN IS PRESSING AHEAD AT FULL SPEED. THE SOVIETS HAVE RECOVERED FROM THEIR EARLIER CONFUSION ON LINKAGE, BUT THE LINE ON THE NATURE OF THE SOVIET DEMAND ~~STILL~~ REGARD TO SOI REMAINS INCONSISTENT. THE SOVIETS CONTINUE TO INSIST THAT U.S. SPOKESMEN HAVE DISTORTED SEVERAL ASPECTS OF REYKJAVIK.

END MESSAGE

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THE PUBLIC CAMPAIGN

3. TWO WEEKS AFTER REYKJAVIK, THE SOVIET PUBLIC PRESS ON REYKJAVIK IS IN FULL SWING. IN ADDITION TO THE EXPECTED ARRAY OF ARTICLES, COMMENTARIES, AND OTHER REPORTS OF SUPPORT FOR THE SOVIET POSITION, THE MEDIA CAMPAIGN HAS FEATURED THREE MAJOR TELEVISION APPEARANCES BY GORBACHEV. THE LAST OF THESE, WE SUSPECT, WAS PROMPTED BY FRUSTRATION -- ONLY THINLY

DEPARTMENT OF STATE A/CDC/MR

REVISED by RA DATE 11/16/89
 () UNCLASSIFIED () DECLASSIFIED
 () EXEMPT () EXEMPTED ONLY in PART
 () EXEMPT () EXEMPT-Reportable Info.
 () EXEMPT-Partial Exemption 61 63 95
 TS authority to:
 OADR

DISGUISED IN GORBACHEV'S OCTOBER 22 SPEECH -- THAT THERE HAS NOT BEEN MORE SUPPORT IN THE WEST FOR SOVIET PROPOSALS, MORE PRESSURE ON WASHINGTON TO CHANGE ITS STANCE ON SOI, AND THAT ADMINISTRATION SPOKESMEN ALLEGEDLY DISTORT THE REYKJAVIK RECORD.

PRINCIPAL THEMES

4. THE SOVIET CAMPAIGN IS BUILT UPON SEVERAL PRINCIPAL THEMES:

--AN "HISTORICAL" OPPORTUNITY FOR A BREAKTHROUGH ON ARMS CONTROL WAS MISSED IN REYKJAVIK DUE TO THE AMERICANS' STUBBORN INSISTENCE ON SOI, WHICH IS NOW THE MAIN OBSTACLE TO NUCLEAR DISARMAMENT;

--THE SOVIET SIDE CAME TO ICELAND WITH NEW PROPOSALS AND MADE IMPORTANT CONCESSIONS (INCLUDING AGREEING TO PERMIT SOI RESEARCH), WHILE THE U.S. CAME WITH "EMPTY HANDS";

--"MILITARIST" CIRCLES IN THE WEST, NOT WANTING AN END TO THE ARMS RACE, ARE SEEKING TO DERAIL THE PROCESS SET IN MOTION BY REYKJAVIK;

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--U.S. SPOKESMEN ARE DISTORTING, FOR THEIR OWN ENDS, WHAT TRANSPIRED AND WHAT WAS AGREED AT THE MEETING; AND

--THE U.S. IS SEEKING TO CHANGE THE ABM TREATY WHILE THE USSR IS CALLING FOR ITS STRICT OBSERVANCE.

5. HAVING MADE SOME OR ALL OF THE ABOVE POINTS, THE VAST MAJORITY OF SOVIET COMMENTARIES HAVE ALSO BEEN CAREFUL TO NOTE THAT POSITIVE ACCOMPLISHMENTS WERE ACHIEVED AT REYKJAVIK; THAT THE ARMS CONTROL DIALOGUE IS NOW ON A "QUALITATIVELY" DIFFERENT LEVEL; AND THAT FURTHER PROGRESS IS POSSIBLE. VIRTUALLY EVERY ARTICLE THAT APPEARS IN THE SOVIET PRESS ON THE ICELAND MEETING -- NO MATTER HOW NEGATIVE IT MAY BE ON THE U.S. POSITION -- CONCLUDES WITH A NOTE OF OPTIMISM.

DIFFERENT INTERPRETATIONS OF REYKJAVIK

6. AS NOTED ABOVE, THE SOVIETS HAVE BEEN CHARGING USG SPOKESMEN WITH DISTORTING THE RECORD OF REYKJAVIK. AMONG THE DIFFERENT INTERPRETATIONS WHICH HAVE BEEN AIRED PUBLICLY ARE:

--WHETHER THE LEADERS AGREED TO ELIMINATE BALLISTIC MISSILES, ALL STRATEGIC OFFENSIVE NUCLEAR ARMS, OR ALL

NUCLEAR WEAPONS;

--WHETHER SRINF LIMITS WOULD PERMIT THE U.S. TO MATCH
THE SOVIET LEVEL OR FREEZE EACH SIDE AT CURRENT
NUMBERS;

--WHETHER THE USSR OR U.S. SOUGHT CHANGES IN THE ABM

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AMEMBASSY BRUSSELS
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C O N F I D E N T I A L SECTION 02 OF 03 MOSCOW 18493

E.O. 12356: DECL: OADR
TAGS: PARM, PROP, UR
SUBJECT: SOVIET PUBLIC LINE ON REYKJAVIK

TREATY:

--WHETHER THE FIFTY PERCENT REDUCTION WOULD APPLY
TO STRATEGIC OFFENSIVE ARMS GENERALLY OR TO EACH LEG
OF THE STRATEGIC TRIAD; AND

--WHETHER GORBACHEV SPRUNG THE "PACKAGE" NATURE OF
SOVIET PROPOSALS AT THE END OF THE MEETINGS OR MADE IT
CLEAR SOONER.

DETAIL ON REYKJAVIK

7. DURING THE LAST TWO WEEKS, THE SOVIETS -- AND
PARTICULARLY GORBACHEV -- HAVE GONE INTO CONSIDERABLE
DETAIL ON THE DISCUSSIONS BETWEEN THE TWO LEADERS.
PRAVOA REPORTED THAT GORBACHEV TOLD VISITING DANISH
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PRIME MINISTER SCHLUETER THAT IT SEEMED NO LONGER
DESIRABLE TO PROTECT THE CONFIDENTIALITY OF TALKS WITH
THE U.S., GIVEN "THE UNPRECEDENTED DISTORTION" OF
EVENTS AT REYKJAVIK IN THE U.S. PRESS. (THIS DOES NOT
EXPLAIN, HOWEVER, WHY GORBACHEV FELT HE COULD GO
INTO SUCH PUBLIC DETAIL IN HIS OCTOBER 12 PRESS CON-
FERENCE OR OCTOBER 14 SPEECH.) WHAT THIS MEANS FOR
THE SOVIET APPROACH TO FUTURE CONFIDENTIAL EXCHANGES
REMAINS TO BE SEEN.

LINKAGE

8. AFTER A WEEK OF CONTRADICTIONS AND CONFUSION ON THE ISSUE OF LINKAGE -- SPECIFICALLY, WHETHER AN INF AGREEMENT COULD BE CONCLUDED WITHOUT A SETTLEMENT OF THE SDI QUESTION -- THE SOVIETS APPEAR TO HAVE STRAIGHTENED OUT THEIR PUBLIC LINE. AT AN OCTOBER 17 PRESS CONFERENCE (REF A), SOVIET NEGOTIATOR KARPOV EXPLAINED THAT WORK COULD GO FORWARD SEPARATELY IN EACH OF THE THREE NEGOTIATING GROUPS, BUT ADOPTION OF AN AGREEMENT IN ANY ONE AREA WOULD HAVE TO BE CONSIDERED PART OF A PACKAGE. OTHER COMMENTATORS HAVE TAKEN UP THIS LINE (THOUGH, IN HIS OCTOBER 22 SPEECH, GORBACHEV EMPHASIZED ONLY THE PACKAGE NATURE OF THEIR REYKJAVIK PROPOSAL). HOWEVER, SOVIET SPOKESMEN HAVE YET TO COME UP WITH A PERSUASIVE RATIONALE FOR THE INF-SOI LINKAGE.

9. [REDACTED]

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[REDACTED]

WHERE'S THE TEST BAN?

10. THE MORATORIUM AND PROPOSED COMPREHENSIVE TEST BAN -- WHICH DOMINATED SOVIET PUBLIC COMMENTARY ON ARMS CONTROL FROM AUGUST 18 UP TO JUST BEFORE REYKJAVIK -- SEEM NOW TO BE GETTING LIP SERVICE AS THE SOVIET MEDIA CAMPAIGN SHIFTS ITS AIM TO SDI. THE SOVIETS OUTLINE REYKJAVIK PROPOSALS AS CONSISTING OF THREE PARTS: (1) START REDUCTIONS, (2) INF CUTS, AND (3) STRENGTHENING THE ABM TREATY REGIME AND NEGOTIATING A TEST BAN, BUT THE TEST BAN QUESTION HAS BEEN LARGELY OVERTAKEN BY THE FOCUS ON SDI AND THE ABM TREATY.

SOI RESEARCH

--IN HIS OCTOBER 14 SPEECH GORBACHEV CITED A DRAFT

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P 241615Z OCT 86
FM AMEMBASSY MOSCOW
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AMEMBASSY BRUSSELS
AMEMBASSY THE HAGUE

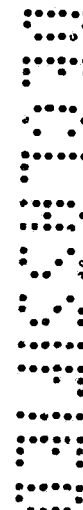
CONFIDENTIAL SECTION 03 OF 03 MOSCOW 18493

E.O. 12356: DECL: OADR
TAGS: PARM, PROP, UR
SUBJECT: SOVIET PUBLIC LINE ON REYKJAVIK

SOVIET PROPOSAL THAT IT WOULD BE "PROHIBITED TO TEST ALL
SPACE ELEMENTS OF AN ABM DEFENSE, EXCEPT FOR RESEARCH
AND TESTING CONDUCTED IN LABORATORIES." (IT IS UNCLEAR
WHETHER GORBACHEV INTENDED "ELEMENTS" TO BE SYNONYMOUS
WITH "COMPONENTS.")

--OVCHINNIKOV IN PRAVDA ON OCTOBER 17 AND OTHER COMMENTATORS
WHO MAY HAVE A LESS EXPERT UNDERSTANDING OF THE ABM TREATY, HAVE DISCUSSED
A MORE GENERAL BAN ON RESEARCH AND TESTING OUTSIDE
OF THE LABORATORY.

--PSEUDONYM GEORGIYEV, WRITING IN PRAVDA ON OCTOBER 18,
(REF B), APPEARED TO CALL ONLY FOR STRICT COMPLIANCE
WITH THE ABM TREATY.



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TEXT OF TELEGRAM 86MOSCOW018493

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--IN A ROUNDTABLE BROADCAST OCTOBER 19, GEN. CHERVOV
CHARACTERIZED THE SOVIET POSITION AS "SPACE TESTS OF ABM
COMPONENTS MUST BE BANNED UNDER ANY CIRCUMSTANCES."

12. T

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